

Third Conditional

CEFR B2

Lesson Pack · summary, worksheet & answer key

Quick answer

The third conditional (if + past perfect, would have + past participle) is for imagining a different past. Use it for:

- 1 Regrets and criticism — If I had studied, I would have passed.
- 2 Imagining a different result — If they had left earlier, they wouldn't have missed the flight.

It's about a past that didn't happen. Use had + participle in the if-clause and would have + participle in the result.

At a glance

Clause	Verb form	Example
If-clause (the condition)	if + past perfect (had + participle)	If I had known,
Main clause (the result)	would have + past participle	I would have told you.

Learning objectives

- Can form the third conditional with if + past perfect and would have + past participle (CEFR B2).
- Can use it for regrets, criticism and alternative past results.
- Can distinguish it from the second conditional.

Practice worksheet

Circle the correct option. Third Conditional · CEFR B2

Name: _____

Date: _____

1. If I ____ harder, I would have passed the exam.

- | | |
|------------|----------------|
| A. studied | B. had studied |
| C. study | D. would study |

2. If you had asked, I ____ you.

- | | |
|---------------|----------------------|
| A. would help | B. would have helped |
| C. helped | D. will help |

3. If they had left earlier, they ____ the flight.

- | | |
|------------------|-------------------------|
| A. wouldn't miss | B. wouldn't have missed |
| C. didn't miss | D. won't miss |

4. If she ____ the message, she'd have come.

- | | |
|---------|--------------|
| A. saw | B. had seen |
| C. sees | D. would see |

5. If I had known, I ____ you.

- | | |
|--------------------|--------------------|
| A. would have told | B. would have told |
| C. would told | D. will tell |

6. Correct this: 'If I studied, I would have passed.'

- | | |
|---|---------------------------------------|
| A. If I had studied, I would have passed. | B. If I study, I would have passed. |
| C. If I had studied, I would passed. | D. If I would have studied, I passed. |

7. If we had trained harder, we ____ the match.

- | | |
|--------------|-------------------|
| A. would win | B. could have won |
| C. win | D. will win |

8. If I ____ to bed earlier, I would have felt better this morning.

- | | |
|---------|-------------|
| A. went | B. had gone |
| C. go | D. would go |

9. Rewrite with the same meaning: 'I didn't know, so I didn't call you.'

- | | |
|---|-----------------------------|
| A. If I had known, I would have called you. | B. If I knew, I'd call you. |
| C. If I know, I'll call you. | D. I call you if I know. |

10. If I ____ more time, I would have finished the essay.

- | | |
|-------------|---------------|
| A. had | B. had had |
| C. have had | D. would have |

Answer key

Correct answers with explanations · for the teacher

1. **B. had studied** — The if-clause uses the past perfect: 'If I had studied'.
2. **B. would have helped** — The result uses 'would have + participle': 'I would have helped you'.
3. **B. wouldn't have missed** — The imagined past result uses 'wouldn't have missed'.
4. **B. had seen** — The if-clause uses the past perfect: 'If she had seen the message'.
5. **A. would have told** — 'Would have + participle': 'I would have told you' (tell → told).
6. **A. If I had studied, I would have passed.** — The third conditional is all past: 'If I had studied, I would have passed'.
7. **B. could have won** — 'Could have' can replace 'would have': 'we could have won'.
8. **B. had gone** — The if-clause uses the past perfect: 'If I had gone to bed earlier'.
9. **A. If I had known, I would have called you.** — An imagined past takes the third conditional: 'If I had known, I would have called you'.
10. **B. had had** — 'Had had' = auxiliary 'had' + participle 'had': 'If I had had more time'.